grand adventure, I could see that. What a privilege it would be, I thought, to join her on that journey.

I got all of that from her face. Her luminous, angelic face. I'd never had a firm opinion on that burning question: Is there just one person on this earth for each of us? But in that moment I felt there might be only one *face* for me.

This one.

I sent Violet a message. *Who…is…this…woman?*

She answered straightaway. *Yeah, I've had six other guys ask me.*

Great, I thought.

Who is she, Violet?

Actress. She's in a TV show called Suits.

It was a drama about lawyers; the woman played a young paralegal.

American?

Yeah.

What's she doing in London?

Here for the tennis.

What's she doing at Ralph Lauren?

Violet worked for Ralph Lauren.

She's doing a fitting. I can connect you guys, if you like.

Um, yes. Please?

Violet asked if it would be all right to give the young woman, the American, my Instagram handle.

Of course.

It was Friday, July 1. I was due to leave London the next morning, heading to the home of Sir Keith Mills. I was to take part in a sailing race on Sir Keith's yacht, around the Isle of Wight. Just as I was stuffing the last few things into my overnight bag I glanced at my phone.

A message on Instagram.

From the woman.

The American.

Hello!

She said she'd got my info from Violet. She complimented my Instagram page. Beautiful photographs.

Thank you.